What Wins ODI Matches?

Data-driven recommendations for the team coach

2,316
ODI matches

1.26M
balls analyzed

2002–2023
seasons covered

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How I analyzed the data

Turned 1.26 million deliveries into match, player, and team tables in Excel.



Prepare

Summed balls into innings totals, decided winners, found each player's batting position and role.



SUM & AVERAGE

1,052,818 runs and 34,181 wickets in total. Average 1st-innings score: 247.



SORT & FILTER

Ranked top batters and bowlers; filtered 5,000+ run scorers and economical bowlers.



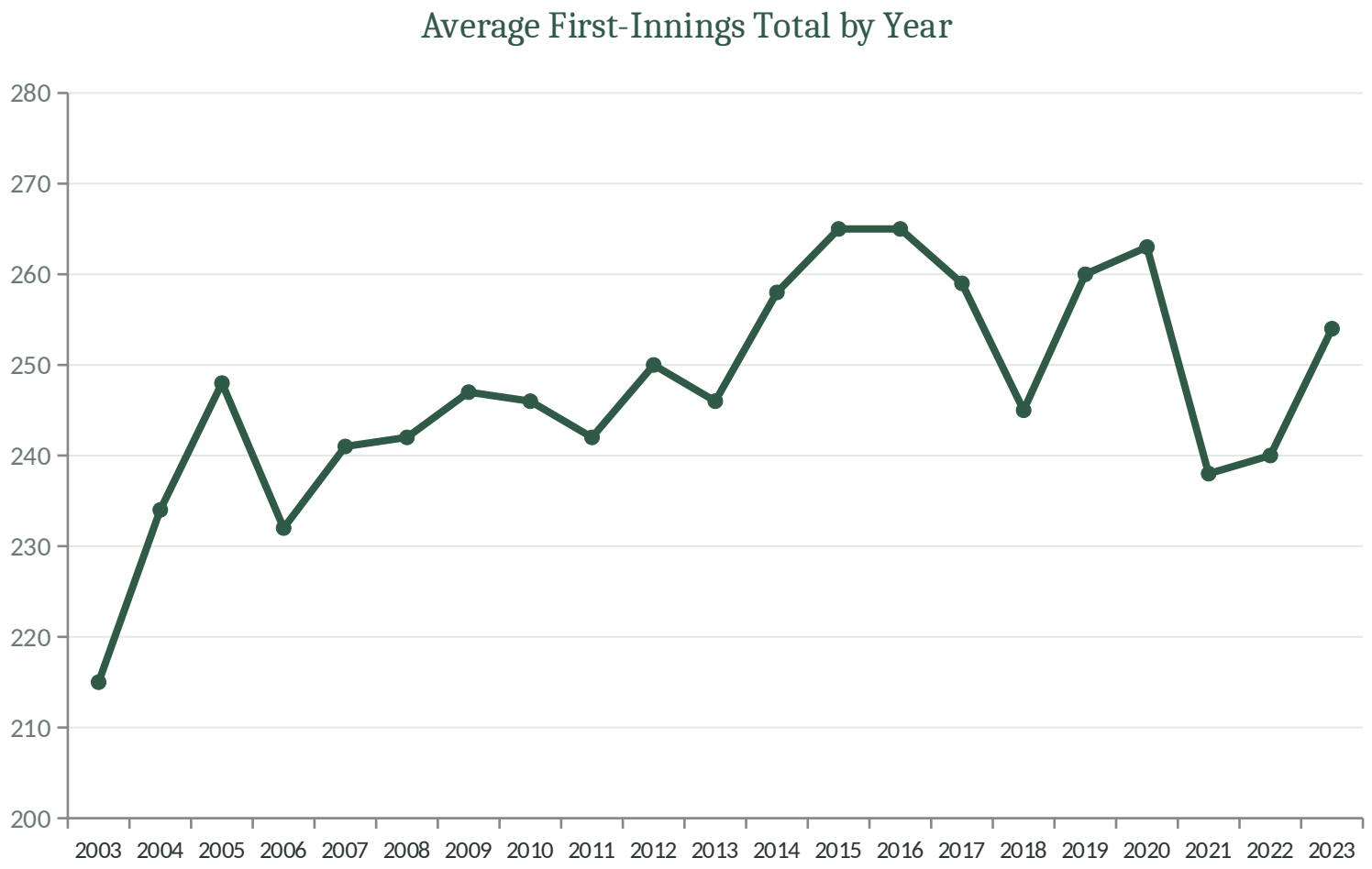
Pivot & charts

Pivot table of wins by year and result; 8 charts on the dashboard.

Source: Kaggle, ODI Men's Cricket Match Data 2002–2023 (ball-by-ball). Analysis in Excel.

Q1. Patterns: scores keep rising, toss barely matters

Average first-innings totals climbed about 40 runs since 2003, while chasing and defending win almost equally.



52% vs 48%

Chasing teams won 1,092 decided matches; teams batting first won 999.

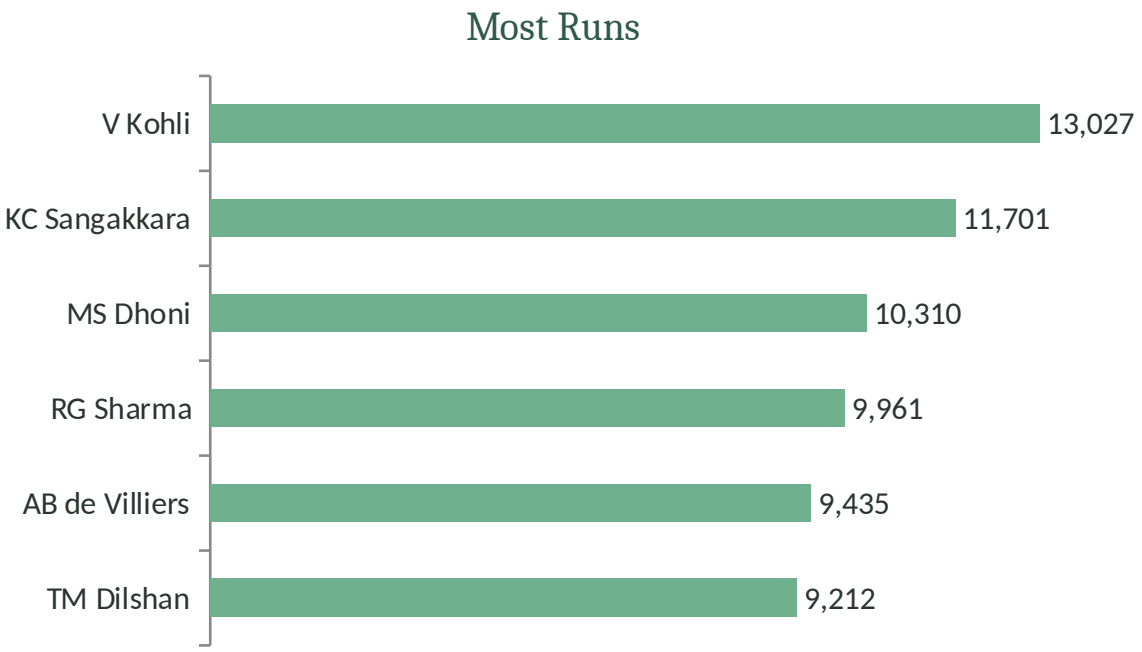
215 → 254

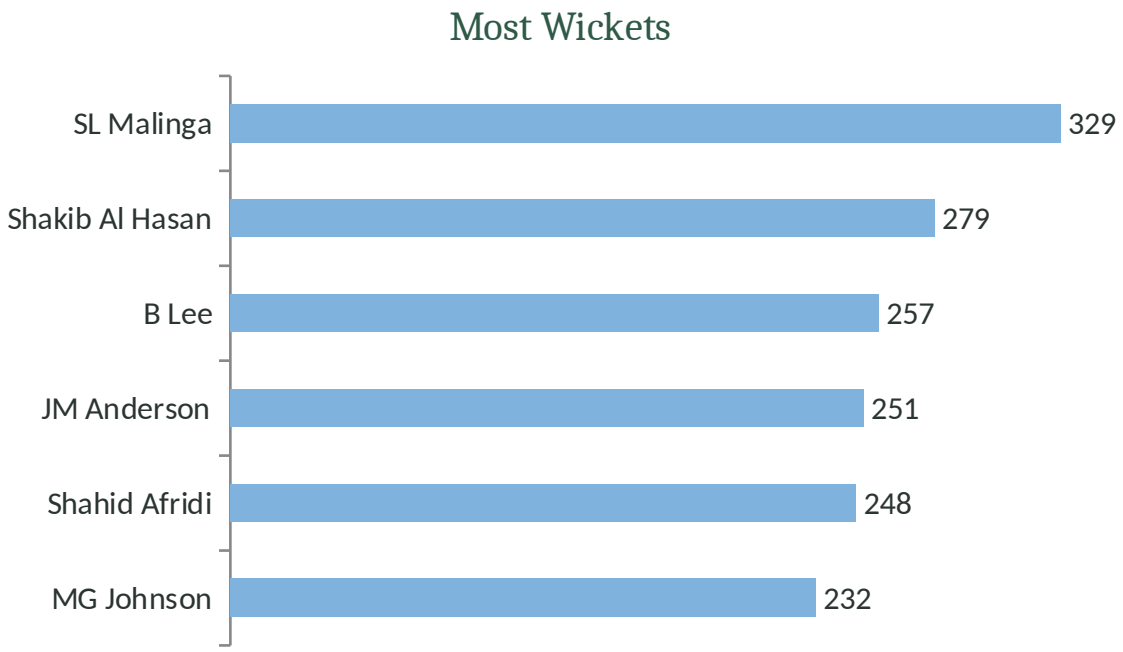
Average first-innings score, 2003 to 2023. A "safe" target keeps moving up.

Source: Kaggle, ODI Men's Cricket Match Data 2002–2023 (ball-by-ball). Analysis in Excel.

Q2. Players with the best performance metrics

Volume and quality: the leaders combine high totals with strong averages and strike or economy rates.





Kohli
avg 57.4, SR 93.8

Babar Azam
avg 58.2

de Villiers
SR 101.2

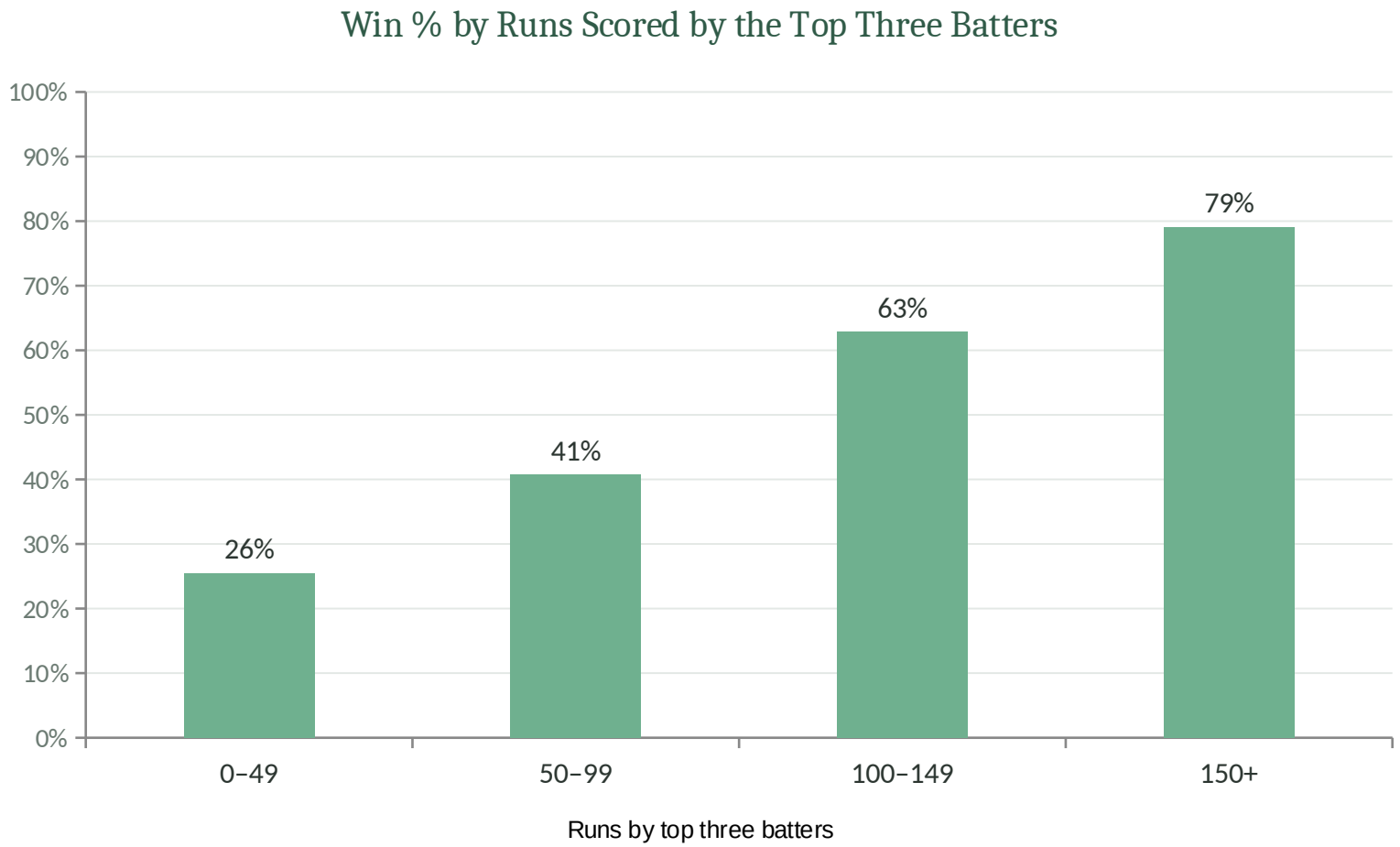
Rashid Khan
bowl avg 19.1

SM Pollock
economy 3.43

Source: Kaggle, ODI Men's Cricket Match Data 2002–2023 (ball-by-ball). Analysis in Excel.

Q3. Winning strategy: a strong top three

The more the top three batters score, the more often the team wins.



3×

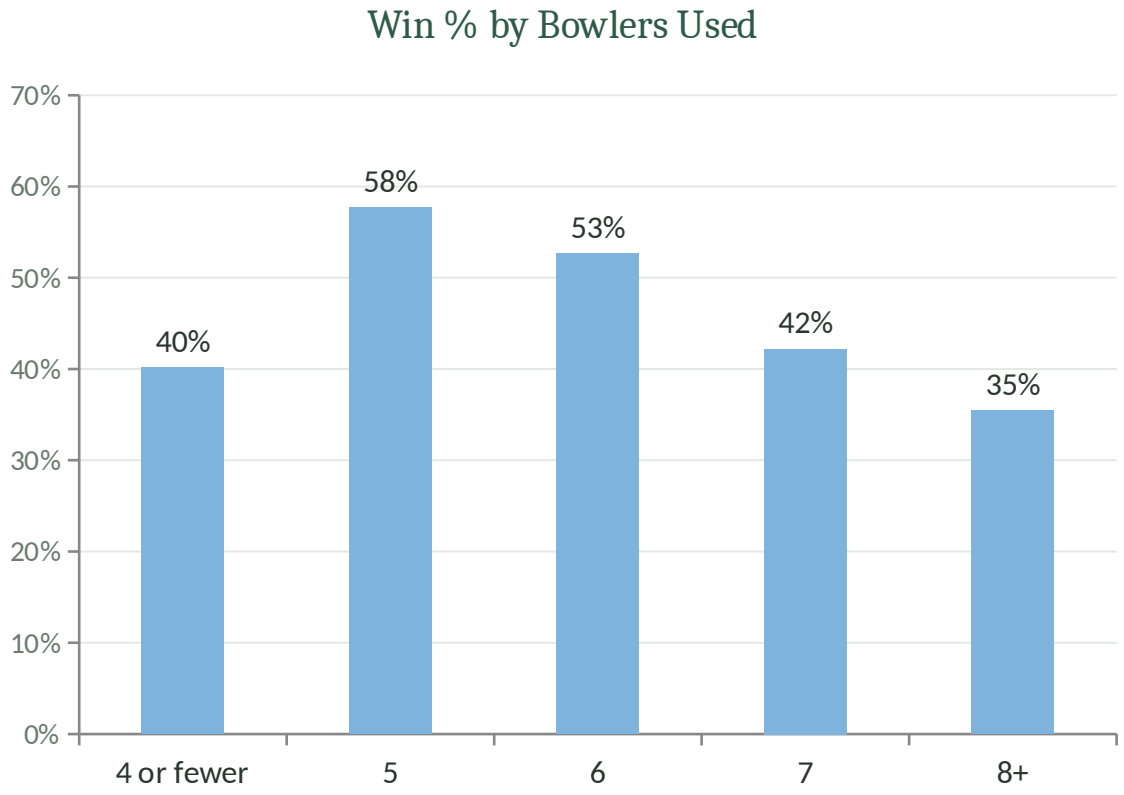
more likely to win when the top three make 150+ (79%) than when they make under 50 (25%).

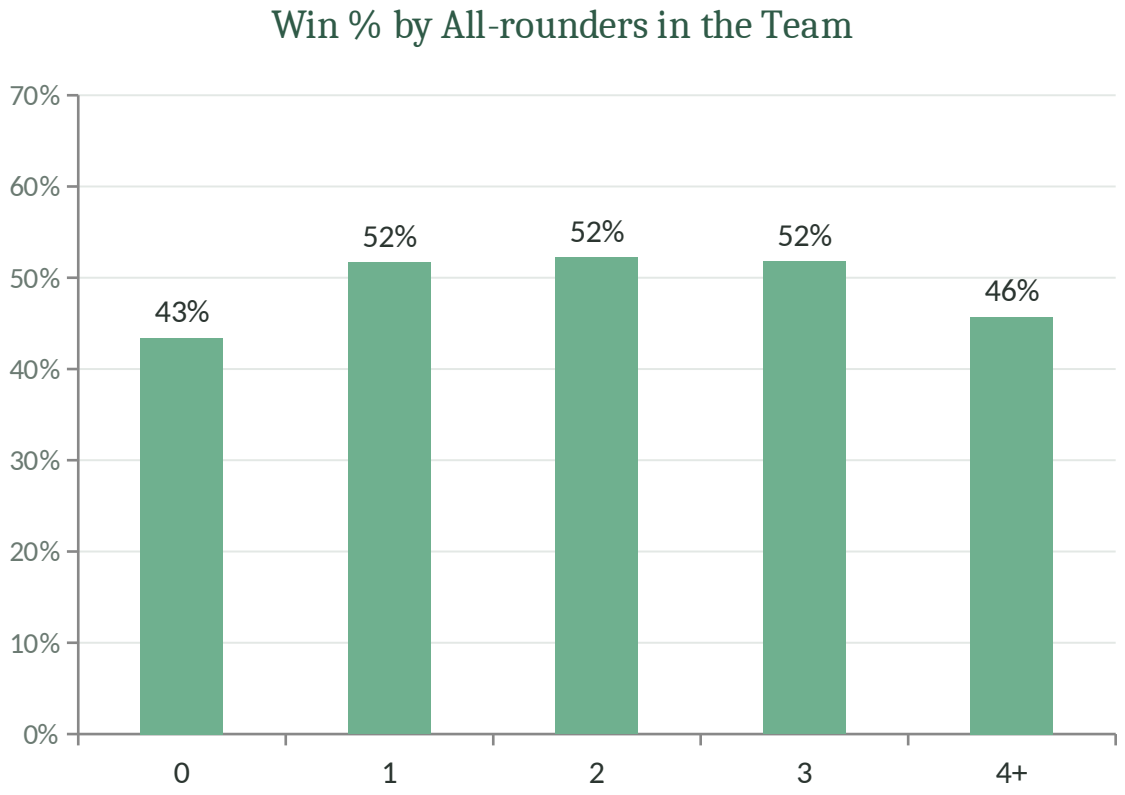
Also works: a 5–6 bowler attack and totals above 260.

Source: Kaggle, ODI Men's Cricket Match Data 2002–2023 (ball-by-ball). Analysis in Excel.

Q4. Team composition: balance beats extremes

Five or six real bowlers and one to three all-rounders give the best win rates.





Why: needing 7+ bowlers usually means the main bowlers were being hit, and having no all-rounders leaves the team short of depth. Top teams like Australia (65% wins), South Africa (63%) and India (62%) field balanced line-ups.

Recommendations for the coach

Three data-backed moves to improve the team's win rate.



Build around the top three

Pick high-average, settled openers and a No. 3. A 150+ top-three score means a 79% win rate.



Five bowlers + 1–2 all-rounders

Teams using 5–6 bowlers won 53–58%. One to three all-rounders lift wins from 43% to about 52%.



Target 260+ batting first

The average first-innings total is now about 254 and rising, so aim above it.

Thank you

Use of AI: I used Claude (Anthropic) to help process the ball-by-ball data, build the Excel tables, formulas and charts, and draft this summary. I checked the key numbers against the data.

Source: Tomar, U. (2023). ODI men's cricket match data (2002–2023) [Data set]. Kaggle. https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/utkarshtomar736/odi-mens-cricket-match-data-2002-2023